

Spoken Tutorial on APIs

Module	Module 3: An Introduction to Building with AI
Episode	3. APIs, API Keys, and API Requests
Learning Objective	At the end of this tutorial learner will be able to 1. Define what an API is. 2. Explain the role of an API Key. 3. Identify components of an API request.
Approx. Duration	3-4 min
Outline	• API Analogy: Restaurant Waiter • API Key • API Request
Meta Tags	API, API Key, API Request, AI, Artificial Intelligence, Building with AI, Prompting, Spoken Tutorial, Web Development, Integration, Data Exchange
Pre-requisite Tutorial	Module 2: Art of the Prompt

Script

Visual Cue	Narration
Title Slide	Welcome to this Spoken Tutorial on APIs .
Learning Objectives Slide	In this tutorial, you will learn to, • Define what an API is. • Explain the role of an API Key. • Identify components of an API request.
System Requirements Slide	Here I am using a browser on a computer or mobile.
Pre-requisite Slide	To follow this tutorial, you should have completed Module 2: Art of the Prompt.
Illustration of a restaurant waiter taking an order from a customer (application) and delivering it to the kitchen (AI model), then bringing back the food (response).	What is an API ? API stands for Application Programming Interface. Think of an API like a restaurant waiter. You give your order, or request, to the waiter. The waiter takes it to the kitchen, which is like the AI model. Then, the waiter brings back your dish, which is the AI response. So, an API acts as a messenger between applications.

Close-up of a hand holding an ID card labeled 'API Key' next to a restaurant menu, emphasizing authentication.	Now, how does the restaurant know you are a valid customer? You might show an ID card. An API key is just like your restaurant ID card. It is a unique identifier, a secret password. This key authenticates your application. It proves you are authorized to make requests. Always keep your API key private and secure.
Illustration of a customer placing an order with a waiter, with thought bubbles showing 'API Request' and 'API Key'.	You place your order with the waiter. This action is similar to an API request. An API request is sending information to an API. You send it to get a specific service. Your API key is usually included for authentication. It is like placing your order to the waiter.
Screen close-up: a smartphone displaying a food delivery app with 'pizza' typed in the search bar, and search results appearing.	Let us see an API request in action. Open any food delivery app on your phone. Tap the search bar and type 'pizza'. The app sends an API request to the server. This request includes your search query and location. The server's API processes this request. It finds relevant pizza places. The API sends these results back to your app. Your app displays them on your screen.
Summary Slide	Let us summarize what we learned. We defined APIs as messengers between applications. API keys are for authenticating your requests. API requests are how you ask for AI services. It is all like ordering food at a restaurant.
Assignment Slide	Now as an assignment, Observe an everyday app you use. Can you identify where an API request might be happening? Think about what information is sent and received. Compare the results.
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